

# CHINEMELU OKAFOR

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Harvard University Government Department  
Cambridge, Massachusetts 02138

Email: [cokafor@g.harvard.edu](mailto:cokafor@g.harvard.edu)  
Website: [www.chinemeluokafor.com](http://www.chinemeluokafor.com)

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| <b>Research Interests</b>        | Political economy; comparative politics; public economics; economic development; economic history; narrative economics; MSME development in emerging markets; international economics and trade                                                                                    |                          |
| <b>Education</b>                 | <b>Harvard University</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Cambridge, MA            |
|                                  | Ph.D. Government, <i>Karl Deutsch Fellow</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2028 ( <i>expected</i> ) |
|                                  | <i>Committee:</i> Melani Cammett (chair), Mashail Malik, Nathan Nunn, Pia Raffler, Awa Ambra Seck                                                                                                                                                                                  |                          |
|                                  | <b>Princeton University</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Princeton, NJ            |
|                                  | Emerging Scholars in Political Science Program                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | August 2021              |
|                                  | <b>The George Washington University</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Washington, DC           |
|                                  | M.A. Applied Economics, <i>Dean's Award</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | May 2018                 |
|                                  | <b>The University of Michigan</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Ann Arbor, MI            |
|                                  | B.A. Economics, B.A. International Studies                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | May 2015                 |
| <b>Works in Progress</b>         | The Origins of Women's Economic and Political Participation in Africa [Abstract]<br>Protest Matters: The Effects of Protests on Economic Redistribution, <i>Under Review</i> , [NBER WP]<br>The Effects of Women-Led Protests on Gender Gaps in Political Participation [Abstract] |                          |
| <b>Selected Teaching</b>         | Harvard: Spring '26 '25 - Business & Entrepreneurship in Africa (HBSMBA 1555), Hakeem Belo-Osagie<br>Harvard: Fall '25 '24 - Public Economics (ECON 1410), Stan Veuger<br>Harvard: Spring '25 - Evaluating the Impact of Public Policies (GOV 1737), Prof. Michael Hiscox          |                          |
| <b>Academic Affiliations</b>     | Harvard Center for International Development, PhD Affiliate                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | January 2025 - Present   |
|                                  | Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Graduate Associate                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | August 2024 - Present    |
|                                  | Harvard Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Graduate Affiliate                                                                                                                                                                                                              | October 2022 - Present   |
|                                  | LBS Wheeler Institute's African Research Councillors Programme, Collaborator                                                                                                                                                                                                       | May 2022 - Present       |
| <b>Selected Presentations</b>    | American Political Science Association Annual Meeting ( <i>2026</i> )                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                          |
|                                  | PhD Excellence Initiative Conference, Stanford University ( <i>2026</i> )                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                          |
|                                  | Harvard Center for African Studies Contested Realities Workshop ( <i>2025</i> )                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                          |
|                                  | London Business School, Wheeler Institute - African History Through the Lens of Economics ( <i>2022</i> )                                                                                                                                                                          |                          |
|                                  | J-PAL Research Staff Training, Massachusetts Institute of Technology ( <i>2020, 2022</i> )                                                                                                                                                                                         |                          |
| <b>Professional Distinctions</b> | Econometric Society Africa Summer School (AFSS)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | June 2026                |
|                                  | Association for Comparative Economic Studies (ACES) Summer School                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | July 2025                |
|                                  | American Political Science Association Member Spotlight                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | July 2025                |
|                                  | Harvard Department of Government Karl Deutsch Fellowship                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | August 2021              |
|                                  | Harvard Graduate School of Arts and Sciences Graduate Prize Fellowship                                                                                                                                                                                                             | August 2021              |
|                                  | American Political Science Association Diversity Fellowship                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | December 2020            |
| <b>Selected Awards</b>           | Harvard Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Dissertation Writing Fellowship                                                                                                                                                                                              | August 2026              |
|                                  | Harvard Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Pre ( <i>x2</i> ) & Mid-dissertation Grant                                                                                                                                                                                   | April 2026               |
|                                  | John C. Hansen & Katherine Vogelheim, Research Grant                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | January 2026             |
|                                  | Harvard Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, GSA Grant ( <i>x2</i> )                                                                                                                                                                                                      | October 2025             |
|                                  | Harvard Center for African Studies, Travel Grant                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | May 2025                 |

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|                             | Harvard Government Department, Women and Politics Research Grant                                                                                                                                             | April 2025                   |
|                             | Harvard Jens Aubrey Westengard Scholarship                                                                                                                                                                   | May 2024                     |
|                             | Forbes 30 Under 30 N. America: Education - Founder, Research in Color Foundation                                                                                                                             | November 2022                |
|                             | Harvard Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Summer Language Grant                                                                                                                                  | April 2022                   |
|                             | Best Overall Performance in the Applied Economics Master's Program, <i>Dean's Award</i>                                                                                                                      | May 2018                     |
| <b>Professional Service</b> | Reviewer for: <i>The Annual Review of Economics</i>                                                                                                                                                          |                              |
|                             | Harvard Concentration Advisor, Thesis Advisor and Non-Resident Tutor                                                                                                                                         | August 2024 - Present        |
|                             | Harvard Resident Tutor, <i>Winthrop House</i>                                                                                                                                                                | August 2021 - August 2023    |
|                             | Specialities: French Language, Public Service, First-gen Low-income, Economics, and Government                                                                                                               |                              |
|                             | The Research In Color Foundation                                                                                                                                                                             | May 2019 - Present           |
|                             | <u>Founder and President</u>                                                                                                                                                                                 |                              |
|                             | Founded and lead <u>Research In Color</u> a 501(c)(3) non-profit which seeks to increase the number and improve retention of historically excluded scholars in economics and economics-adjacent disciplines. |                              |
| <b>Research Experience</b>  | <b>White House Council of Economic Advisers</b> ( <i>took leave from PhD</i> )                                                                                                                               | Washington, DC               |
|                             | Staff Economist                                                                                                                                                                                              | August 2023 - August 2024    |
|                             | <b>Advisors:</b> Dr. Sandile Hlatshwayo                                                                                                                                                                      |                              |
|                             | <b>Areas of focus:</b> International Economics and Trade; Section 201 & 301 Tariffs                                                                                                                          |                              |
|                             | <b>Selected Projects:</b> Economic Report of the President, Chapter 4, <i>Council of Economic Advisers</i> 2024                                                                                              |                              |
|                             | <b>Emerging Scholars in Political Science Program</b>                                                                                                                                                        | Princeton, NJ                |
|                             | Predocutorial Research Specialist                                                                                                                                                                            | August 2019 - August 2021    |
|                             | <b>Advisors:</b> Prof. Leonard Wantchekon                                                                                                                                                                    |                              |
|                             | <b>Area of focus:</b> Historical applied microeconomics;                                                                                                                                                     |                              |
|                             | Digitized historical maps of Nigeria in QGIS to support ongoing research on the long-run effects of colonial missionary education on present-day living standards, occupation, and political participation   |                              |
|                             | <b>Empirical Studies of Conflict Project</b>                                                                                                                                                                 | Princeton, NJ                |
|                             | Research Specialist II                                                                                                                                                                                       | September 2018 - August 2019 |
|                             | <b>Advisors:</b> Prof. Tarek Ghani and Prof. Jake Shapiro                                                                                                                                                    |                              |
|                             | <b>Areas of focus:</b> Natural resource extraction and conflict in Sub-Saharan Africa;                                                                                                                       |                              |
|                             | Preprocessed spatial data and created interactive map of Africa by merging firm-level ownership identifiers of extractive sites in oil, gas, and mining, to instances of violent conflict                    |                              |
|                             | <b>Selected Projects:</b> Mining Competition and Violent Conflict in Africa, <i>Journal of Politics</i> 2025                                                                                                 |                              |
|                             | <b>The International Finance Corporation (IFC)</b>                                                                                                                                                           | Washington, DC               |
|                             | Research Assistant                                                                                                                                                                                           | February - October 2018      |
|                             | <b>Advisors:</b> Dr. Tristan Reed and Dr. Alexandros Ragoussis                                                                                                                                               |                              |
|                             | <b>Areas of focus:</b> Private sector firm development in Sub-Saharan Africa;                                                                                                                                |                              |
|                             | Created indicators of infrastructure access and ran synthetic panel fixed effects regressions to measure inclusiveness and equality of markets to electric power and water for households                    |                              |
|                             | <b>Selected Projects:</b> Making It Big: Why Developing Countries Need More Large Firms, <i>IFC</i> 2020;                                                                                                    |                              |
|                             | Creating Impact: The Promise of Impact Investing, <i>IFC</i> 2019;                                                                                                                                           |                              |
|                             | Beyond Capital: Monitoring Development Outcomes of Multinational Enterprises, <i>World Bank</i> 2018                                                                                                         |                              |
|                             | <b>The World Bank</b>                                                                                                                                                                                        | Washington, DC               |
|                             | Consultant                                                                                                                                                                                                   | June - August 2017           |
|                             | <b>Advisors:</b> Kinley Salmon and Nabila Assaf                                                                                                                                                              |                              |
|                             | <b>Areas of focus:</b> Major challenges to firm operations in post-conflict settings;                                                                                                                        |                              |
|                             | <b>Selected Projects:</b> Surviving Firms of the Syrian Arab Republic, <i>World Bank</i> 2018                                                                                                                |                              |
| <b>Skills</b>               | RStudio, R Shiny, STATA, L <sup>A</sup> T <sub>E</sub> X, ArcGIS, Qualtrics, JavaScript, Microsoft Office Suite                                                                                              |                              |
| <b>Languages</b>            | English (Native proficiency), French (Upper-intermediate proficiency), Igbo (Passive proficiency)                                                                                                            |                              |